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TO: The President (Military Archives Division)
 FROM: George C. MARSHALL, Chief of Staff brief Memorandum
 OF: February 26, to President Franklin D. ROOSEVELT about
 the "terrific" Los Angeles air alarm.

111 51347-06

February 26, 1942.

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Section

MEMORANDUM FOR THE PRESIDENT:

The following is the information we have from GHQ at this moment regarding the air alarm over Los Angeles of yesterday morning:

"From details available at this hour:

"1. Unidentified airplanes, other than American Army or Navy planes, were probably over Los Angeles, and were fired on by elements of the 37th CA Brigade (AA) between 3:12 and 4:15 AM. These units expended 1430 rounds of ammunition.

"2. As many as fifteen airplanes may have been involved, flying at various speeds from what is officially reported as being 'very slow' to as much as 200 MPH and at elevations from 9000 to 18000 feet.

"3. No bombs were dropped.

"4. No casualties among our troops.

"5. No planes were shot down.

"6. No American Army or Navy planes were in action.

"Investigation continuing. It seems reasonable to conclude that if unidentified airplanes were involved they may have been from commercial sources, operated by enemy agents for purposes of spreading alarm, disclosing location of antiaircraft positions, and slowing production through blackout. Such conclusion is supported by varying speed of operation and the fact that no bombs were dropped."

DECLASSIFIED

E.O. 11652, Sec. 3(e) and 5(D) or (E)

OSD Memo, May 3, 1972

By 1A NARS Date 4-9-74

(Sgd) G. C. MARSHALL

Chief of Staff.

MCM

Orig. dispatched to Pres.

2/26/42

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